# TOPIC 1 · INTRODUCTION TO DEEPFAKES AND AI-GENERATED CONTENT

**8 minutes** · meaning of deepfakes · how AI creates content · genuine vs generated · uses and misuse

## What is it?

**Artificial intelligence (AI)** is software that learns patterns from very large amounts of data and then uses those patterns to predict, sort or create. **Generative AI** creates new content — a paragraph, a picture, a song or a video — from a short instruction.

A **deepfake** is a photo, video or audio clip made or altered with AI so that a real person seems to say or do something they never did. The word joins “deep learning” (the AI method) and “fake”.




*Figure 3.3 · How a deepfake is made and spread*

| Genuine or AI-generated? | Genuine content usually… | AI-generated or manipulated content often… |
|---|---|---|
| Origin | Can be traced to a known camera, author or outlet | Has no clear original; first appears in forwards or a new account |
| Details | Has natural imperfections; consistent shadows and text | Looks too smooth, or shows odd hands, teeth, ears or text |
| Context | Fits the date, place and other reliable reports | Cannot be matched with any real event or reliable report |
| Purpose | Informs, entertains or reports | Pushes you to act fast: pay, click, forward or keep a secret |



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| Helpful and legitimate uses | Harmful misuse |
|---|---|
| Dubbing films and lessons into many languages, with consent | Voice-clone calls that fake an emergency to get money |
| Restoring a voice for people who have lost it to illness | Fake videos of celebrities promoting “money-doubling” trading apps |
| Training simulations in schools, hospitals and industry | Morphed or sexual images made to shame or blackmail a person |
| Clearly labelled art, satire and entertainment | Fake audio or video of leaders spreading rumours during elections or disasters |

## Real-life case · the video call where everyone was fake

In early 2024, an employee of a multinational firm's Hong Kong office joined a video call with people who looked and sounded like the company's finance chief and colleagues. On their instructions he made a series of transfers worth about US$25 million. Every other person on the call was a deepfake.

**Lesson:** seeing a familiar face on a live call is no longer proof. Large or unusual requests must be confirmed through a separate, known channel.

## Remember

The technology is neutral. Consent, labelling and intent make the difference between creative work and a crime.

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# TOPIC 2 · AI-GENERATED IMAGES, VIDEOS AND VOICES

**10 minutes** · fake photographs · face swaps and lip-sync · voice cloning · clues and their limits · detection tools

## What is it?

AI can now produce a **photograph of a person who does not exist**, **swap one face onto another** in a video, make a real person's **lips match new words** (lip-sync), and **clone a voice** from a short sample so that it can say anything typed into it.

Some clues can reveal manipulation, especially in quickly made fakes. But tools improve every month, and a good fake may show no clue at all. Clues raise suspicion; they do not prove anything either way.

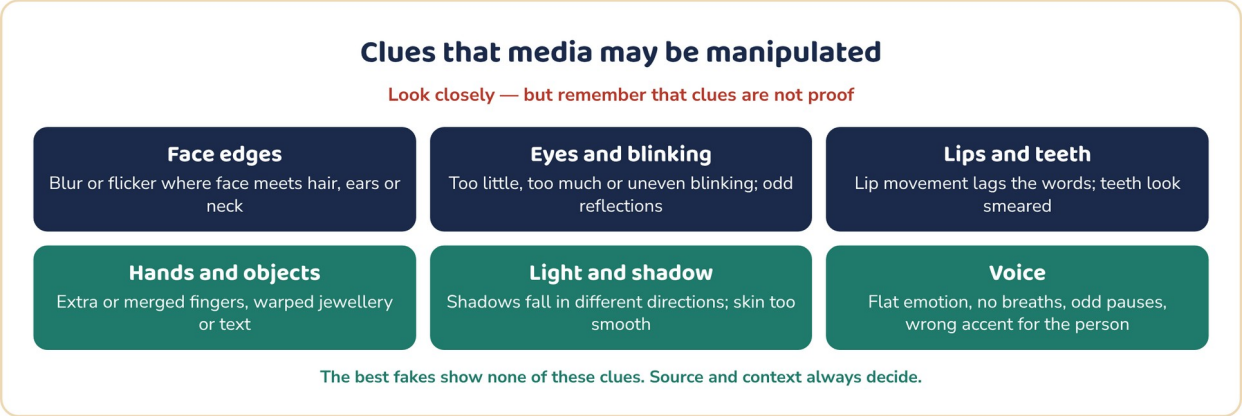



*Figure 3.4 · Clues that media may be manipulated*

| Type | How it is made | What to check first |
|---|---|---|
| AI photo | Generated from a text prompt or edited by AI ("remove", "add", "change face") | Hands, text, jewellery, background objects; reverse image search for the original |
| Face swap video | A face from photos is mapped onto another person's body | Face edges, skin tone at the neck, blinking, head turns |
| Lip-sync video | Real video of the person; only the mouth is changed to new audio | Lips against sounds such as "p", "b", "m"; teeth; voice quality |
| Voice clone | AI copies voice from reels, videos or voice notes | Emotion, breathing, background noise; above all, call back on a known number |

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## Detection tools: useful, but not a judge

Online "deepfake detectors" give a percentage such as "72% AI". Treat this as **one clue**. Detectors can be wrong both ways, can be fooled by compression on WhatsApp, and are not accepted as proof by themselves. A call-back, the original source or a fact-check carries far more weight.

| Myth | Fact |
|---|---|
| **"I can always tell a fake by looking."** | Studies and real cases show that people are often fooled; verification beats eyesight |
| **"If the detector says real, it is real."** | Detectors miss new methods and compressed files |
| **"Only famous people are deepfaked."** | Ordinary people are targeted for sextortion, harassment and voice-clone fraud |
| **"A live video call cannot be faked."** | Real-time face and voice swapping is available to criminals |

## Ask yourself

- Where did this image, video or voice come from first?
- Am I relying on how it looks, or on where it came from?
- Is it asking me to pay, click, forward or keep a secret?

| Stop | Save | Report |
|---|---|---|
| Do not forward, pay or act on the content yet. | Save the link, account name, date and time; screenshot the post (not intimate content). | Report fake profiles and content to the platform; fraud or threats to cybercrime.gov.in. |

## Remember

Clues raise suspicion; only source, context and independent confirmation settle the question.

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# TOPIC 3 · FAKE NEWS AND MISINFORMATION

**10 minutes** · mis-, dis- and malinformation · misleading headlines · how false content spreads · health, disaster and election rumours

## What is it?

**False information** ranges from honest mistakes to deliberate campaigns. It spreads fastest when it triggers fear, anger or pride, and when it arrives from someone we trust. In India, false forwards have caused panic during health emergencies and disasters, and have even led to mob violence.




*Figure 3.5 · Three kinds of false information*




*Figure 3.6 · Why false content spreads faster than truth*

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| Common pattern | Example | How to check |
|---|---|---|
| Old photo, new claim | Flood picture from another country shared as "our city today" | Reverse image search for the earliest date and place |
| Misleading headline | Headline says "ban"; article says "proposal under study" | Read the full article and the official source |
| Fake official notice | "Government gives ₹5,000 to all students — register here" | Official ministry website; PIB Fact Check |
| Miracle health cure | "This kitchen remedy cures diabetes in 7 days" | Doctor or official health ministry advice; reliable fact-checkers |
| Edited clip | Speech cut to reverse its meaning | Find the full video from the original channel |

## Where to check

- **PIB Fact Check** (factcheck.pib.gov.in) checks claims about the Government of India; claims can be sent to its WhatsApp tipline.
- **Independent fact-checkers** that follow the International Fact-Checking Network code, and reliable news outlets that name their sources.
- **Official websites** of the ministry, department, police or company concerned — typed by you, not opened from the message.

## Remember

If you cannot verify it, do not forward it. Silence does no harm; a false forward can.

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# TOPIC 4 · IMPERSONATION AND MANIPULATED MEDIA

**10 minutes** · fake profiles · misuse of photos · morphed and intimate images · sextortion · victim-centred response

## What is it?

**Impersonation** means pretending to be someone else — through a fake profile using their photos, a hijacked account, or AI media of their face or voice. **Morphing** is editing a person's photo, often onto a sexual image, to shame or blackmail them. **Sextortion** is threatening to share intimate or morphed images unless the victim pays or sends more images.

The person shown is a victim, whether the image is real or fake. Shame keeps victims silent, which is exactly what the criminal relies on.




*Figure 3.7 · Responding to morphed images and sextortion*

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| Do | Never |
|---|---|
| Say clearly: “This is not your fault. You are not in trouble.” | Blame the victim for posting photos or chatting |
| Check immediate safety and distress; involve a trusted adult for a minor | Ask to see the image, or ask the victim to send it to you |
| Save the profile link, username, chat and time | Copy, forward or store the image — even as “evidence” |
| Use StopNCII.org (adults) or Take It Down (under 18) to block re-uploads by hash | Pay the demand or negotiate with the criminal |
| Report to the platform, cybercrime.gov.in and police; 181 or 1098 as needed | Promise that every copy will disappear from the internet |

## What the law and platforms provide

Under the IT Rules 2021, platforms must act on a complaint about intimate or morphed images of a person within 24 hours. Publishing such material is an offence under the IT Act 2000 (ss. 66E, 67, 67A; s. 67B for children) and the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita 2023; impersonation online is an offence under IT Act s. 66D. Child sexual material is reported at once; it is never copied or viewed (Modules 5 and 7).

## Real-life case · Ayesha's Instagram photos

Ayesha, 22, received a message with a morphed image made from her public Instagram photos and a demand for ₹5,000. A friend trained as a First Responder told her it was not her fault, helped her save the account link and chat, used StopNCII to create a hash of the image on her own phone, reported the account and filed on cybercrime.gov.in. The account was removed; no payment was made.

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# TOPIC 5 · AI-BASED CYBER THREATS AND PHISHING

**10 minutes** · voice-clone emergencies · AI-written phishing · deepfake adverts · fake video calls · chatbots

## What is it?

Criminals use AI to make old scams more convincing: **cloned voices** of relatives, **flawless phishing messages** in any language, **deepfake adverts** of celebrities and business leaders promoting trading apps, and **live face-swap video calls** pretending to be police or company officials.

The defence is the same as in Module 2 — check the **request**, not the polish — plus one new habit: **verify through a channel you already trust.**

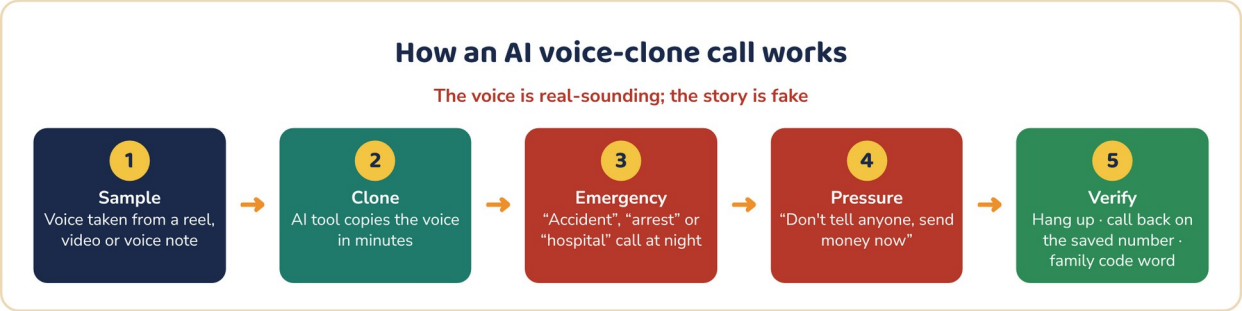



*Figure 3.8 · How an AI voice-clone call works*

### Old scams vs AI-powered scams

AI removes the mistakes we were taught to look for

| Feature | Older scam messages | AI-assisted scam messages |
|---|---|---|
| Language | Spelling and grammar errors | Fluent, polite, in any Indian language |
| Personal touch | Generic "Dear customer" | Uses your name, job, recent posts |
| Voice and video | Text only | Cloned voices and live face-swap video calls |
| Scale | Same message to everyone | Thousands of unique messages, chatbots that reply |
| What still works | Check the request, not the polish | Verify through a channel you already trust |

*Figure 3.9 · Old scams vs AI-powered scams*

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| Threat | What it looks like | Safe response |
|---|---|---|
| **Voice-clone emergency** | Relative's voice: accident, arrest, hospital; money now; don't tell anyone | Hang up; call back on the saved number; family code word |
| **Deepfake investment advert** | Famous face recommends an app or WhatsApp group with “guaranteed” returns | No genuine celebrity endorses guaranteed returns; check SEBI registration (Module 2) |
| **Fake video call by “officials”** | Uniform, office backdrop, demand for money or secrecy | End the call; there is no digital arrest; 1930 |
| **AI chatbot scam** | Friendly “customer support” or “recruiter” that answers every question | Contact the company only through its official website or app |
| **Fake boss or colleague** | Voice note or video from a senior asking for an urgent transfer or gift cards | Confirm in person or on a known number; follow the organisation's approval rules |

## Ask yourself

- Did I verify this person through a number or channel I already had?
- Is there a request for money, secrecy or speed?
- Would the real person or organisation ask this way?

| Stop | Save | Report |
|---|---|---|
| End the call or chat; do not decide under pressure. | Save the number, voice note or video link, and the time. | Money lost: 1930 and cybercrime.gov.in. No loss: report the number on Chakshu (sancharsaathi.gov.in). |

## Remember

A familiar voice or face is no longer proof. Call back on a number you already know.

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# TOPIC 6 · CONTENT VERIFICATION, RESPONSIBLE AI USE AND PRIVACY

**12 minutes** · S·I·F·T routine · reverse image and video search · recording a verdict · consent and labelling · protecting your image and voice

## What is it?

**Verification** is a routine, not a feeling. The S·I·F·T routine — Stop, Investigate the source, Find better coverage, Trace to the original — works on photos, videos, voice notes and headlines alike. The honest result is one of three verdicts: **genuine**, **fake**, or **cannot verify yet**.




*Figure 3.10 · The verification routine: S·I·F·T*




*Figure 3.11 · Reverse image and video search in five steps*

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| Tool | Use it for | Limit |
|---|---|---|
| Google Lens / Bing Visual Search / TinEye | Finding earlier copies of a photo or video frame | May not find very new or private images |
| Video keyframe tools (e.g. InVID-WeVerify) | Splitting a video into frames to search them | Needs a browser on a computer |
| Official websites and PIB Fact Check | Claims about government schemes and notices | Covers government-related claims only |
| Independent fact-checkers | Viral claims, edited clips, rumours | May take time for a brand-new claim |
| Metadata viewers | Date and camera of an original file | Social media usually strips metadata |

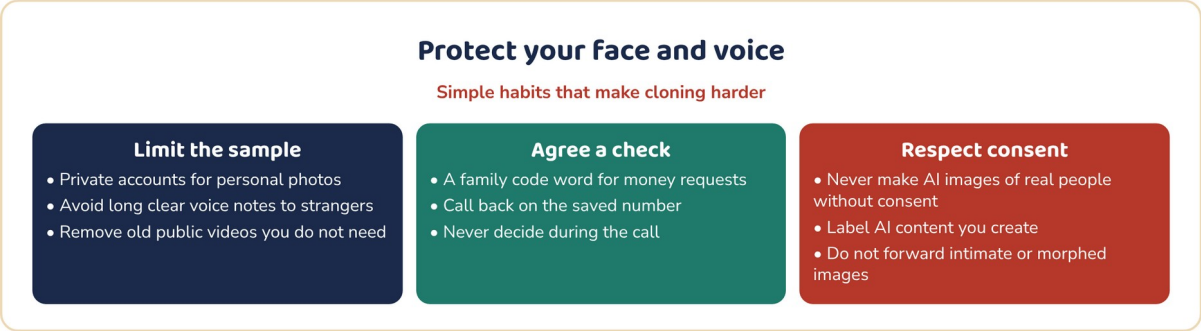



*Figure 3.12 · Protect your face and voice*

## Responsible AI: the consent rule

Creating AI images, video or voice of a real person without their consent can violate their privacy and dignity and may be an offence. Under the DPDP Act 2023, a person's image and voice are personal data. Label AI-generated content you share, never use AI to sexualise, mock or impersonate a real person, and never feed someone else's private photos into an AI tool.

## KEY TAKEAWAYS FROM MODULE 3

| Takeaway | In one line |
|---|---|
| Seeing is not believing | Faces and voices can be faked cheaply; source and context decide |
| Clues are not proof | Neither are detector scores; use them only as a reason to check |
| S·I·F·T every time | Stop · Investigate the source · Find better coverage · Trace to the original |
| Victims are never to blame | Save links, not images; StopNCII or Take It Down; report |
| Consent first | No AI media of real people without consent; label what you create |

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